

1917, May

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

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(cont'd.)

in like manner, "O God what the glory of Heaven must be "When its feeble reflection on mountain and lea, enrobes the dull clay with such beauty sublime - Eternity's breath on the ashes of time!" Ah, eternity's breath on the ashes of time," is all material beauty - all material grandeur, greatness! But, dear br., if this is the case - if the sun and all that is visible is but a shadow, then we may ask "What must be the reality?" If the sun the material lord of the visible heavens is so dazzeling in himself and so wonderful in his effects and reflections, what must be the glory of the Divine Creator & His goodness & power & love? If the stars are beautiful as they reflect the light of the sun at such immeasurable distances what will be the beauty of the saints who for all eternity and not at a distance - will reflect the divine image of God! Will love God and one another with the purity and ardor of the Holy Ghost Himself! Is it a wonder that St. Paul, having been ravished to the 3rd heaven, is it any wonder that he should cry out, "--eye hath not seen, ear hath not heard nor hath it entered into the heart of man to conceive what things God has prepared for them that love Him!" Is it any wonder that St. Francis of Asissi should go into ecstasy at first sound of an angel's instrument and assure us that he would have expired of pure joy had the angle drawn his bow a second stroke! But dear Br. if such is the indescribable happiness of Heaven in general, if the glory of the saints is so indescribable - what shall we begin to say of the Immaculate Queen of Heaven? What may we say of her glory, of her love of God, of her influence in Heaven? If she outshone all the saints and angels in the first instant of her conception as the rising moon outshines the stars who can begin to imagine her present glory? And yet her humility! "Behold the handmaid of the Lord!" If humility increases with real sanctity as its roots descend with the growth of a tree, what must Mary's humility now be? Before the Incarnation, her most ardent prayer was for the coming of the Messiah. She longed to see and to serve the Virgin who was to be His Mother. ---And behold the messenger of Almighty God awaits her consent to be herself the Tabernacle of the Most High! "Be it done to me --" With the words conceived in her heart, she is She remains - the Virgin Mother of God.